

Parks Department Meeting March 18th 2025

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=EuDm_zfVOtA
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Muny Park and Recreation Board Meeting Summary

Meeting Date: Tuesday, March 18, 2025

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Presiding officer called the Muny Park and Recreation Board meeting to order at [00:00:20](#).
- **Attendance:**
 - **Present:** Chandra Parks, James Lutton, Shannon Powers, Brad Marshall
 - **Absent:** Mark Irvin (noted in advance due to a conflicting meeting commitment)
 - **Presiding Officer:** Brad Marshall (inferred from role guiding agenda items and entertaining motions)

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The meeting opened with the Pledge of Allegiance [00:00:24](#).
- **Approval of Minutes:** The minutes from the February meeting were approved by voice vote with no discussion or revisions [00:01:10](#).

4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- **00:01:22 Superintendent Report & Department Updates**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Carl Malone, Parks Superintendent
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Carl Malone provided updates on post-weather park cleanups (removing broken branches and limbs), camera system upgrades for park safety, and assistance at Perry Creek. The city is the leading city host for the upcoming IP state conference. Perry Creek repairs include fixing walk boards and recovering 17 weather-damaged piers from the lake with assistance from the Muncie Fire Department. Riverview Park restroom installations are awaiting renderings and a start date. The pool at Tui will open Memorial Day weekend and close Labor Day weekend, managed by contractor Bun, Bond and More. Westside Park is close to completion, but a temporary sewer line repair needs long-term engineering review. Thomas Park water lines and a shut-off valve for the splash pad have been installed. Park restrooms across the city are targeted to open this weekend. Seasonal park hiring is underway through HR. Junior, a key staff member with over 30 years of experience at Perry Creek, is transferring to the street department. Discussion also covered mulch costs (\$7,000<U+2013>\$8,000 per park) and the long-term benefit of synthetic rubber surfaces.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational report only; no formal vote taken.
- **00:12:04 Summer Internship Program & Upcoming Events**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Nikki (Program Director)
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Nikki reported 148 applicants for the summer internship program following in-person registrations. Interviews are scheduled between March 24 and April 4. National Kids to the Park Day is scheduled for May 17 at Canon Commons (12:00 PM to 4:00 PM) with games, bounce houses, a DJ, and a balloon guy. Flag football registration has a few spaces left, and summer sports programming is being finalized.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational report only.
- **00:14:37 6th Annual Juneteenth Celebration Event Approval**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Nikki (Program Director) / Event organizers
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Presented the 6th annual Juneteenth celebration scheduled for June 14 at McCullough Park, expecting around 500 attendees. Muncie Police Chief Sloan agreed to provide police presence. Organizers requested bleachers, a large stage, large tent, horses, and the cabin from the parks department (which will be invoiced), while port-a-potties and trash cans will be ordered directly through sanitation.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote **00:16:45**.

- **00:18:07 Perry Creek Report**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Kelly (Perry Creek representative) / Carl Malone
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Kelly reported on winter storm damage to docks east of the sailboat club (17 docks / 34 slips damaged). The Muncie Fire Department is assisting with debris removal as part of training. The sailboat club is donating old docks, a barge, and assistance. The department is looking to purchase a pontoon boat under \$10,000 to push plastic docks. Discussions also addressed wastewater compliance issues at the campground dump station raised by the state and water company, with a high-level meeting scheduled at the mayor's boardroom on April 7.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational report only; no formal vote taken.
- **00:28:45 Friends of Prairie Creek 2025 Season & Easter Egg Hunt**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Jackie Cisco, President of Friends of Prairie Creek
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Jackie Cisco presented the 2025 season agenda, noting an opening meeting on April 11 and an Easter egg hunt on Saturday, April 19, relocated to the main office area due to community building reservations. Donations of candy and small prizes are requested.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational report only.
- **00:31:46 Security Systems Proposals (Heekin & Pulley Bathrooms)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Sam (Security Pros) & Carl Malone
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Sam presented proposals for surveillance cameras at Heekin Park basketball courts and access control/timer systems for the Pulley Park bathrooms (which have been closed for two years). Police Chief Nate Sloan reviewed and generally approved the proposals. Discussion included adding infrared and motion sensor lighting at Tui Pool to deter trespassing.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational report only; proposals submitted for board review.
- **00:37:16 Prairie Creek Trail Phase Three Contract**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Carl Malone
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Carl Malone noted that the contract needs board approval before going to the Board of Works. Staff is awaiting a formal written agreement from American Water confirming support for the project. Flatland (running the project) agreed to a one-month delay to secure the formal response from American Water.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Deferred/Delayed by consensus for one month
- **00:38:20.**
- **00:38:33 Recreational Programming & Summer Grants**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Shannon Powers

- **Deliberation Summary:** Shannon outlined upcoming summer programs, including a free “Learn to Swim” program for 85<U+2013>100 children funded via a state health department grant at Tui Pool, a 3-month ultimate frisbee program at Heekin Park on Wednesday and Thursday evenings, Aqua Zumba and water aerobics, morning group exercise at Canon Commons, and chair yoga/line dancing at McCullough Park.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational report only.
- **00:40:49 Pool Management & Swim Club Contracts**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Carl Malone
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Discussed the YMCA pool management contract for Tui Pool, the Cardinal Swim Club pool rental contract, and the summer program contract between the City of Muncie, NAACP, and the parks department.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational report only; contracts submitted for review.
- **00:43:09 Skate Park Signage & Construction Security**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Carl Malone
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Carl noted that despite “no trespassing” signs and orange fencing, individuals are entering the unfinished skate park site. Proper operational hours and safety signage must be posted prior to official opening. Board members emphasized the need for more robust contractor site security in future contracts to prevent liability and unauthorized access.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational report only.
- **00:46:34 New Business: Proposed Summer Basketball League at McCullough Park**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Marwin (Zion) Strong, CEO of Foreverlasting & Battle of the Brands
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Marwin Strong proposed hosting a summer-long, full-court 5-on-5 basketball league at McCullough Park starting June 21, running weekends (Saturdays and Sundays, 4:00 PM to 8:00 PM) targeting collegiate, high school, and professional athletes (ages 15 and up). The event will feature local small business vendors and private security (coordinating with the sheriff’s office or Robert Scafe’s security service). Carl Malone expressed strong support.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** Marwin Strong presented the proposal directly during new business.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational presentation; scheduled dates/forms to return to the board for formal approval.
- **00:51:53 New Business: Sanitation Department Interlocal Agreement for Park Trash Service**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Carl Malone

- **Deliberation Summary:** Carl reported initial discussions with the sanitation department regarding an interlocal agreement for managing trash collection in city parks. The arrangement would involve minimal to no cost to the board, potentially requiring the parks' current trash vehicle to be turned over to sanitation in exchange for sanitation managing in-city park trash pickup.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational report; formal proposal expected next month.
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5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

No members of the public signed up or spoke during the general public comment period near the conclusion of the meeting.

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - A high-level meeting with American Water, the Mayor, Carl Malone, and Kelly is scheduled for April 7 at 8:00 AM in the mayor's boardroom to discuss reservoir conditions and lease terms.
 - Holtzman neighborhood event inquiry noted for June 21 to be placed on next month's agenda.
 - **Adjournment:** The meeting was officially adjourned by voice vote following a motion and second **00:57:40**.
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